MCP

Title:
A Trip Through "Monte Carla"

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A TRIP THROUGH “MONTE CARLA”

Characters:

CARLA - a young white girl who had life handed to her...until tragedy struck

MOM - Carla’s dying mother

DAD - Carla’s unfaithful, homosexual father

GREG - Carla’s abusive boyfriend

LIAM - Liam Neeson from *Taken*

BEST FRIEND - Carla’s backstabbing friend

DOCTOR - a walking plot device

SHOW “PROLOGUE”

(The stage is bare. All actors stand onstage facing backwards and act as the set for CARLA. If actors double characters, it is suggested that CARLA’s actor remains the same throughout.)

ACTORS IN UNISON

Now this is a story all about how my life got flipped, turned upside down…

(CARLA emerges from the ensemble and begins monologuing)

CARLA

Hi. I'm Monte Carla. I'm an average girl who has never had anything bad happen to her in her whole entire life. Everything was going great. I had two loving parents. I had a best friend. I was content. Until, you know, the *drama* happened. Boy, was it bad. Especially since I never thought it would happen to me. Because

(pause)

I'M WHITE!

(pause)

I found out so much about myself and my family that I will never forget. The whole experience brought me closer to religion even though I was raised an atheist. You never understand why people fall to their knees until you, too, are driven to a point where only the cool ground can comfort you. Now, amongst the tragedy, I can truly be #blessed! But I left that wretched life behind me and am ready to move on with my life. Who I am is not defined by my past, so maybe one day I'll be stronger and learn how to heal the scars both on my heart and on my body. If you care to hear my story, stay. If you don't, you have to stay too. Thanks and, uh, enjoy my shitshow of a life.

<u>SCENE ONE</u>

CARLA

It started back in May. My mother and I were out shopping when:

(BOOM! A wild MOM appears!)

MOM

Oh honey it's so great to see you.

CARLA

You see me every day, mom.

MOM

I know, but it seems like after your father and I decided not to tell you about our divorce, you've been so distant.

CARLA

You're getting divorced?!

MOM

I knew I should never have told you, but your father insisted. He said if we ever wanted you to see us or trust us again that we should be open and honest. Gosh, I feel so stupid for listening to him.

(distracted)

Ooh, this is a cute skirt! What do you think?

CARLA

That is cute. How much is it?

(shaking head)

NO WAIT! Back up. I thought you and dad were happy.

MOM

We were.

CARLA

Then why get divorced?

MOM

Your father is gay.

CARLA

What?

MOM

It’s true. One day he just...decided to sleep with the milkman behind my back. Literally, behind my back. I was sitting in the other room! They were on the couch, just doing it and listening to 90s Hip Hop!!!

CARLA

(gasps)

Not 90s Hip Hop!

MOM

I could’ve just...died right there.

CARLA

Don’t be melodramatic. You’re not dying.

MOM

I’ve actually been meaning to talk to you about that. Carla, honey, I have cancer.

CARLA

What do you mean you have cancer?!

MOM

Honey don't shout. You don't want me to have a heart attack. You know I have high blood pressure and a heart just itching to pop.

CARLA

No, I actually DON’T know that! Why haven’t you told me any of this?!

MOM

And there goes my heart.

(grabs heart)

I'm going... I'm going... Oh would you look at that? I'm truly dying. Tell your father I never truly stopped loving him.

CARLA

But you aren't even officially divorced yet?

MOM

That doesn't mean I can't love the man I married.

CARLA

But he cheated on you a room away from you. How…?

MOM

It's actually kinda hot. I don't know if I'm more impressed or turned on, but I'm definitely both.

(pause)

OH OW! Yep that's the heart again. Goodbye Carla. I would say I love you but you're actually just adopted and I never really cared about you. Your adoption day was the capital-W Worst day of my life. Goodbye now.

(dies)

(*The actor portraying MOM returns to the ensemble.)*

CARLA

(to audience)

With my mother dead and my father distant, I went out to find something I could believe in. Something that wouldn't shatter my world. That's when I met Greg:

SCENE TWO

(*GREG enters, finger guns flying)*

GREG

You must be

(finger gun)

Carla.

CARLA

How do you know my name?

GREG

I've secretly been stalking you

(finger gun)

but you won't find out until we start dating and I end up slowly making your life worse even though I seemed like I was going to be your

(finger gun)

saving grace.

CARLA

Sounds about right. Say, I'm trying to live on the edge. Would you maybe want to go out?

GREG

More like

(finger gun)

ruin your already shitty life, but sure!

CARLA

Such a gentleman!

GREG

Now I'm going to control you mentally and emotionally so that you are nothing more than a

(finger gun)

shell of what you once were.

(GREG returns to the ensemble)

CARLA

(to audience)

Greg was perfect. Everything I could have ever wanted in a partner. Things were going great with us. Then one day he... Took advantage of me.

(GREG cautiously approaches CARLA)

GREG

Hey, Monte, I don't mean to *take advantage of you* or anything, but

(finger gun)

can you spot me some money? I need a McFlurry because I have a

(finger gun)

CRAVING that cannot be satiated by Blizzards.

(CARLA reluctantly hands money to GREG who runs offstage excitedly)

CARLA

(to audience)

But that wasn't nearly as bad as… *that night...*

(GREG comes back)

GREG

Carla,

(finger gun)

can I be frank with you?

CARLA

Who's Frank?

GREG

No I mean like,

(finger gun)

honest.

CARLA

Oh of course, what is it?

GREG

I cheated on you… with your best friend.

CARLA

What?!

(BEST FRIEND appears and lays a comforting hand on CARLA's shoulder that she quickly brushes away in disgust)

BEST FRIEND

It's true. I let it happen. I wasn't even thinking, I just…

CARLA

I HATE YOU! BOTH OF YOU! Just… stay away from me. Please.

BEST FRIEND

Don't leave!

CARLA

I do what I want!

GREG

If you leave then...we're through!

(*CARLA runs offstage. GREG and BEST FRIEND stare after her pleadingly for a bit and then leave because stage directions)*

CARLA

(to audience)

I lost my best friend and boyfriend that night. It was horrible! But then, as if Greg's infidelity wasn't bad enough, he…

(gets choked up)

he took things too far.

GREG

Hey I'm going to kill you now.

CARLA

What did I do?!

GREG

You left me and I'm a jealous prick so, this just...makes sense.

CARLA

Just when I thought things couldn't get any worse!

GREG

(Stabby Stabby)

CARLA

You literally aren't even stabbing anything

DAD

(Punches GREG)

Don't worry, I'm here, honey!

GREG

What you, GREG- I mean EGG?

(to audience)

Ha! Shakespeare!

(in character once more)

OW! PAIN!

(GREG dies...kinda)

Well, I guess this is it for me. I have been

(*weak finger gun*)

killed.

(actually dies)

CARLA

Dad, what are you doing here?

DAD

I realized I needed to see my baby girl grow up and I couldn't sleep around with that bad hombre anymore because if I can't get on my feet for myself, how would *you* ever be able to, as my blood? I know it sounds conceited, but I feel like I influence every aspect of your life. I needed to save myself to save you. I'm asserting my authority as a parent.

CARLA

Oh dad, even though you suck, I missed you!

(*CARLA and DAD hug and then just like a typical drama piece father, DAD leaves...to the ensemble)*

SCENE THREE

CARLA

(to audience)

Having my dad back in my life was great. We talked about Mom, shared stories, bonded over silly things we both did, picked out cute guys together, attended and organized PTA meetings, it really was a dream come true. OR SO I THOUGHT!

(*Guess who's back, back again… you're right! It's DAD! But only his voice because the actor is hidden in the ensemble. CARLA picks up a ringing phone, and DAD and LIAM hide in the ensemble as mere voices on the other end of the call. They get no body because OPPRESSION IS REAL AND ALIVE TODAY!)*

LIAM

Hello, Monte Carla. I am Bond, James Bond. Haha, I kid. I am LIAM NEESON FROM TAKEN.

(LIAM turns to wink to the audience)

But now, I am the kidnapper. If you ever want to see your flamboyant dad, I suggest you give me a small loan of a million euro.

CARLA

But I don't have any money!

LIAM

What about a college fund?

CARLA

Nope. Bad parents.

LIAM

Credit card?

CARLA

Not for you.

LIAM

Do you have any alpaca fur?

CARLA

Why would I?

LIAM

If you do not have payment, then you do not have a dad. He is my father now.

CARLA

I won't let you get away with this!

LIAM

You already have.

DAD

I'm sorry, Carla. I'm his father now.

CARLA

NOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO!!!!!!!!

(end pla-)

CARLA

Wait, wait, wait. This is not a good ending for a dramatic script. We need more death, more tragedy, more cancer!

LIAM

Uh...I have breast cancer?

CARLA

Perfect! Now, tell me, did you cry when you found out? Will I cry when you die?

LIAM

No.

CARLA

Hmm…

LIAM

But your dad… he's dead.

CARLA

D-d-d-d-deAD?!?!

LIAM

Yes. I shot him.

CARLA

Probably because he was gay! You homophobe!

LIAM

No, I swear! I love the gays!

CARLA

Goodbye, Liam.

(hangs up)

Damn homophobes.

SCENE FOUR

CARLA

(stepping towards audience)

So that's my story. I had a great, normal life. I was happy. My family was happy. Then my dad came out. Now, here I am. An orphan. My mother is dead. My father is dead. I no longer have anything left to love. My life is meaningless. I would kill myself, but…

(CARLA is interrupted as DOCTOR emerges from the ensemble)

DOCTOR

Monte Carla, right?

CARLA

Yeah?

DOCTOR

I'm a medical doctor and I have a degree. So you can trust me.

CARLA

Okay…?

DOCTOR

Carla, you have cancer.

CARLA

WHAT?! But I haven't even gotten tested!

DOCTOR

And AIDS, but what's important is the cancer.

CARLA

But I'm a virgin, Doc.

DOCTOR

Cancer isn't an STD…

CARLA

I MEANT THE AIDS! AIDs is an STD! Some doctor...

DOCTOR

Oh, right. Well, it turns out you're not a virgin.

CARLA

How will I survive?!?!

DOCTOR

Odds are, you won't, but there is a small chance that...

CARLA

Yes?

DOCTOR

There's a small chance you suffer from "Main Character Syndrome"

CARLA

What's that?

DOCTOR

Essentially, it's the idea that even though you have nothing to live for, you will go on for the sake of a decent ending.

CARLA

Hell yeah!

(CARLA attempts to do the high school musical jump (unsuccessfully) while DOCTOR and the ensemble slowly try to leave the stage so that no one will ever associate them with this again.)

(Fin)